



free will
and
determinism

against
compatibilist
free will

A large red circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is arranged in three lines, centered within the circle.

**against
incompatibilist
free will**

This argument seems to show that the combination of four theses — that No one has any choice about the past, no choice about the laws of nature, the no choice principle, and determinism — rules out free will.

Since the first three of these theses seem quite plausible, the argument seems to show that if determinism is true, there are no free actions — and hence that free will is incompatible with determinism.

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

Real/|the master argument:

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe in free will, and find the consequence argument persuasive, it looks tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

But, we'll see now, this argument can also be given a plausible defense.

One way to introduce this defense is with the following quote from

David Hume:

We can introduce an argument against Libertarianism with a thought
experiment:

Now ask yourself: is Alex's choice free? It seems very clear that it is not. It is not up to Alex what he does; and free actions have to be up to the person doing the action.

The Randomizer

Scientists have created a small device called a Randomizer. Pushing a button on the Randomizer starts an indeterministic process which results in a 0 or a 1. Alex's brain is hooked up to a Randomizer. When he is deciding whether to do something, this pushes the button on the Randomizer. If the Randomizer generates a 1, this makes him do the action. If the Randomizer generates a 0, this makes him not do the action.



then DECISION. (4,5)

1. No one has any choice about events which

2. None has any choice about DIDS. ATJR.

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

and none has any choice about whether,

about whether @.

if P , then Q , then one has any choice



6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

varlatatie + the last of the

4. If determinism is true, the laws of

then DECISION happens. (3)

5. No one has any choice about what the laws

of interest.

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

the idealist that is NOT AUR



future is not just what the state of the

3. If determined, the only one

happened in the distant past.

choice about the laws of nature, then no

one has any choice about the past, no

choice principle, and determinism



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reality of free will.

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the

Compatibility believers in free will reject premise (1). An incompatibilist

believe in free will rejects premise (2).

for (2), and one for (3).

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

A large orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text 'against compatibilist free will' in white, bold, sans-serif font.

**against
compatibilist
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actions and actions which are not chance.



Human's basic thought is that there is a big difference between free

Here's a thought experiment:

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